GROWTH MEMO | JERRY

Locked Out at Renewal: How Phone-Only Login May Be Quietly Costing Jerry Renewals

Prepared by Riya Gupta, MBA (Information Systems), San Diego State University | November 2026 | For: Business Operations & Product

The question, and why it matters

Jerry's goal is to grow from 5M to 50M customers. Every customer kept at renewal is one Jerry does not have to win again. Before pulling any data, I asked: **can every customer actually get back into Jerry when it is time to renew?** A real customer's experience suggests some cannot, and that the problem surfaces at the worst possible moment.

What I heard from real users (informal interviews, November 2026)

Who	What they said	Signal
Current customer, switched via Jerry	Found Jerry **through ChatGPT**, compared quotes, switched, and **saves about $100**. Would recommend it because "it's cheap."	High value delivered; a customer worth keeping
Same customer, today	**Locked out.** His account is tied to a phone number he has since **deactivated**, and the app **would not let him log in with his email**.	Access depends on one phone number
Same customer, usage	Opens the app **only at renewal**.	He would discover the lockout only when renewing
Trial user (a friend)	Got a GEICO quote on Jerry, found **GEICO direct** cheaper, and bought direct.	At friction points, the carrier's direct path is one search away

Limits: *one customer's account issue and a small, informal sample of international working professionals in San Diego. These are hypotheses to size with Jerry's data, not conclusions.*

Why this could matter more than it looks

- **Phone numbers change.** People switch carriers and plans, move, or (like many international students and professionals) drop a temporary number. If the number is the only key, the account goes with it.
- **The lockout is silent.** Customers who only open Jerry at renewal will not notice for six to twelve months.
- **It hits at the renewal moment.** That is exactly when a customer must act, and when buying direct from the carrier is easiest.
- **It blocks expansion too.** A customer who cannot log in cannot be offered home, renters, or roadside products.

Hypotheses and how I would test them

#	Hypothesis	Test with data
H1	**Customers whose phone number stops working renew less** than customers with a working number.	Renewal rate for users with failed SMS delivery in the 90 days before term end vs. all others
H2	**Login failures cluster right before renewal,** when customers return after months away.	Failed logins and "can't log in" support tickets by days until term end
H3	**Locked-out customers who reach support renew late or not at all.**	Time to renew and renewal rate for users with an account-recovery ticket
H4	**Some segments are hit harder,** such as recent movers, young drivers, and international residents.	Number-change and lockout rates by segment
H5	**A backup login and a pre-renewal contact check would lift renewals.**	A/B test below

Metrics I would put on one dashboard

- **Renewal-with-Jerry rate,** split by whether the customer's phone number is still reachable.
- **Account recovery success rate** and median time to regain access.
- **Share of customers with a verified backup login method** (email or second number).
- **Failed logins and "can't log in" tickets** in the 30 days before term end.
- **SMS delivery failures** as an early warning that a customer's number is dead.

One experiment to run first: pre-renewal access check

Design: 45 days before term end, prompt customers to confirm their phone number and add an email as a backup login (treatment), vs. today's experience (control). Randomize at the user level.

Primary metric: renewal-with-Jerry rate. **Secondary:** share of customers with a backup login; failed logins near renewal. **Guardrails:** notification opt-outs and app rating.

Sample size (illustrative): if 80% of customers renew today, detecting a lift to 82% at 95% confidence and 80% power needs about **6,000 customers per arm**. At Jerry's scale, one month of renewals should cover it.

SQL sketch: do customers with a dead phone number renew less? (assumed schema, ClickHouse)

```
SELECT (s.failed_sms > 0)                        AS phone_unreachable,
       count()                                   AS policies_due,
       countIf(p.renewed_with_jerry = 1)         AS renewed,
       round(renewed / policies_due, 3)          AS renewal_rate,
       countIf(t.lockout_tickets > 0)            AS had_lockout_ticket
FROM policies AS p
LEFT JOIN (
    SELECT user_id, countIf(status = 'undelivered') AS failed_sms
    FROM sms_messages
    WHERE sent_date BETWEEN '2026-04-01' AND '2026-09-30'
    GROUP BY user_id
) AS s ON s.user_id = p.user_id
LEFT JOIN (
    SELECT user_id, count() AS lockout_tickets
    FROM support_tickets
    WHERE category = 'account_access'
    GROUP BY user_id
) AS t ON t.user_id = p.user_id
WHERE p.term_end_date BETWEEN '2026-07-01' AND '2026-09-30'
GROUP BY phone_unreachable;
```

Recommendation: what I would do in the first 30 days

- **Size it first (H1 to H3).** Run the query above to see how many renewals sit behind a dead phone number.
- **Add a backup login.** Let customers sign in with email, and recover accounts by verifying identity (for example, policy number plus driver's license) when the phone number is gone.
- **Check contact details before renewal** and use SMS delivery failures to trigger an email asking customers to update their number.
- **Create a fast lane in support** for "can't log in" tickets within 30 days of renewal, since those customers are about to decide.
- **Run the A/B test** to measure the renewal lift and build the business case for the fix.

I would welcome the chance to size this with real data. Riya Gupta | guptariya471@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/riyaguptx